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Operating System Questions and Answers – Process Creation

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This set of Operating System Interview Questions and Answers focuses on “Process Creation” and will also be useful for interview preparations.

1. Restricting the child process to a subset of the parent’s resources prevents any process from _____

a) overloading the system by using a lot of secondary storage
b) under-loading the system by very less CPU utilization
c) overloading the system by creating a lot of sub-processes
d) crashing the system by utilizing multiple resources

View Answer

Answer: c
Explanation: Restricting the child process to a subset of the parent’s resources prevents any process from overloading the system by creating a lot of sub-processes. A process creates a ch process. child process requires certain resources to complete its task. A child process can dema

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2. A parent process calling _____ system call will be suspended until children processes terminate.
a) wait
b) fork
c) exit
d) exec

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Answer: a
Explanation: A parent process calling wait system call will be suspended until children processes terminate. A parameter is passed to wait system call which will obtain exit status of child as well as wait system call returns PID of terminated process.

3. Cascading termination refers to termination of all child processes if the parent process terminates _____
a) Normally
b) Abnormally
c) Normally or abnormally
d) None of the mentioned

View Answer

Answer: c
Explanation: Cascading termination refers to termination of all child processes if the par

4. With _____ only one process can execute at a time; meanwhile all other process are waiting for the processor. With _____ more than one process can be running simultaneously each on a different processor.
a) Multiprocessing, Multiprogramming
b) Multiprogramming, Uniprocessing
c) Multiprogramming, Multiprocessing
d) Uniprogramming, Multiprocessing

View Answer

Answer: d
Explanation: With Uniprogramming only one process can execute at a time; meanwhile all other processes are waiting for the processor. With Multiprocessing more than one process can run simultaneously each on different processors. The Uniprogramming system has only one program inside the core while the Multiprocessing system has multiple processes inside multiple cores. The core is one which executes instructions and stores data locally into registers.

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5. In UNIX, each process is identified by its _____
a) Process Control Block
b) Device Queue
c) Process Identifier
d) None of the mentioned

View Answer

6. In UNIX, the return value for the fork system call is ____ for the child process and ____ for the parent process.
a) A Negative integer, Zero
b) Zero, A Negative integer
c) Zero, A nonzero integer
d) A nonzero integer, Zero

View Answer

Answer: c
Explanation: In Unix, the return value of the fork system call is Zero for the child process and Non-zero value for parent process. A fork system call returns the PID of a newly created (child) process to the parent and returns Zero to that newly created (child) process.

7. The child process can _____
a) be a duplicate of the parent process
b) never be a duplicate of the parent process
c) cannot have another program loaded into it
d) never have another program loaded into it

View Answer

Answer: a
Explanation: The child process can be a duplicate of the parent process. The child process created by fork consists of a copy of the address space of the parent process.

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8. The child process completes execution, but the parent keeps executing, then the child process is known as _____

a) Orphan
b) Zombie
c) Body
d) Dead

View Answer

Answer: b
Explanation: The child process completes execution, but the parent keeps executing, then the child process is known as Zombie. When a child process terminates, its resources get deallocated but its entry in the Process Control Block (PCB) remains there until its parent calls wait system call.

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Manish Bhojasia, a technology veteran with 20+ years @ Cisco & Wipro, is Founder and CTO at Sanfoundry. He is Linux Kernel Developer & SAN Architect and is passionate about competency developments in these areas. He lives in Bangalore and delivers focused training sessions to IT professionals in Linux Kernel, Linux Debugging, Linux Device Drivers, Linux Networking, Linux Storage, Advanced C Programming, SAN Storage Technologies, SCSI Internals & Storage Protocols such as iSCSI & Fiber Channel. Stay connected with him @ LinkedIn

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